

CS486 – Design Brief 3

Context Scenarios and Requirements

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1 Vision Statement

TripFit helps young independent travelers choose what to do next during short city trips by turning scattered saved ideas and nearby options into a small, transparent shortlist that fits their current mood, time, energy, budget, weather, and group situation.

2 Context Scenarios

The following context scenarios describe the ideal user experience from the perspective of our main user types. They focus on what the personas need to accomplish and how the product supports their goals, without specifying exact interface widgets.

2.1 Scenario 1: Lina chooses with her group in the middle of the trip

Lina is on a weekend trip in Barcelona with three friends. It is late afternoon. They have just finished visiting a museum earlier than expected, and they now have about three hours before dinner. Everyone is slightly tired. One friend wants a calm café, another wants a viewpoint, and another wants something more lively. Lina has saved many TikToks and Instagram posts before the trip, and the group chat also contains screenshots and map links. However, the saved ideas no longer feel easy to use. Some places are too far, some are too expensive, some seem better for daytime, and some only fit part of the group.

Instead of opening every app again, Lina opens TripFit for a quick decision. She does not want to build a full itinerary. She only wants to answer one question: what should the group do next? TripFit understands that she is already in the city, that this is a short time slot, and that the decision must work for several people. Lina gives a few lightweight signals: the group is low-to-medium energy, the budget is moderate, they prefer something social but not too crowded, and they need to stay within easy reach of their dinner area.

TripFit gathers the group's saved ideas and nearby realistic options into one decision space. It removes options that are closed, too far, too expensive, or poorly matched to the group's current energy. Instead of showing a long list, it gives a shortlist of three options. Each option includes a clear reason: why it fits now, what trade-off it involves, and what could make it a bad choice. For example, one option is close and cheap but less distinctive; another has a stronger atmosphere but requires more travel time; the third is a backup if the weather worsens.

The group now discusses three serious options instead of ten scattered suggestions. Lina feels less responsible for manually integrating everyone's preferences. Her friends can quickly react to the shortlist, and the group agrees on one place. TripFit keeps the second-best option as a

backup in case the first place is crowded. The end result is not necessarily the most famous place in Barcelona, but it fits their actual situation. Lina feels relieved because the decision is faster, more justified, and less likely to waste time or money.

2.2 Scenario 2: Tran makes an efficient decision with one friend

Tran is spending a short weekend in Lyon with one friend. They are not highly spontaneous, but they also do not want to plan every hour. After lunch, they want one more activity before taking the train back in the evening. Tran usually starts with Google Maps and reviews rather than TikTok. Her difficulty is different from Lina's: there is less group negotiation, but she still dislikes wasting time comparing too many reasonable options.

Tran opens TripFit because she wants a practical answer quickly. She indicates that they have two hours, medium energy, and prefer something close rather than ambitious. TripFit looks at their current location, remaining time, opening hours, travel time, and nearby options. It also considers a few places Tran saved earlier, but it does not force her to browse through all of them.

TripFit returns a small set of options ranked by current practicality. The first suggestion is a nearby riverside walk with a café stop. The second is a small museum that still fits the time slot. The third is a neighborhood detour that is slightly more effort but has a stronger atmosphere. For each option, Tran sees the reason it is suggested: distance, time needed, effort level, and why it is still worth considering now.

Tran and her friend choose the riverside walk because it matches their time and energy better than the museum. They do not feel that they sacrificed the "best" option; they feel that they chose the most appropriate one. TripFit has reduced the comparison work without taking control away from them. For Tran, the value of the product is efficiency: it helps her make a good-enough, confident decision without creating another complex planning task.

2.3 Scenario 3: Claire uses TripFit only when the plan breaks

Claire is different from Lina and Tran. She usually plans most of her trips in advance. Before leaving for Copenhagen, she already chose her hotel, main neighborhoods, restaurants, museums, and backup indoor activities. She does not want a tool that replaces her itinerary. For most of the trip, she does not need TripFit.

On the second day, however, the weather changes and one outdoor activity becomes unrealistic. Claire suddenly has two free hours before dinner. She is tired and does not want to search across blogs, maps, and reviews while standing in the street. She opens TripFit as a backup tool, not as her main planner.

TripFit recognizes that Claire is not starting from a blank slate. It uses her current location, available time, saved places, and existing plan. It suggests three low-friction alternatives that fit the gap: a nearby indoor market, a quiet café near the next restaurant, and a short exhibition that can be visited in under one hour. The suggestions are not framed as a new itinerary, but as ways to repair the current plan.

Claire chooses the indoor market because it is close, sheltered, and fits the available time. She appreciates that TripFit respects her planning style: it does not push her into spontaneous discovery for its own sake, but helps when her planned structure breaks down. This confirms that TripFit is mainly designed for semi-spontaneous in-trip decision-making, while still being useful as a smart backup for structured travelers.

3 Task Tree

The original task tree was highly branched and difficult to read as a traditional diagram. We therefore represent it here as a hierarchical task flow. This preserves the same logic: one root goal, an ordered sequence of main tasks, and lower-level subtasks under each stage.

Root goal: Choose a contextually fitting next activity during a short city trip



1. Recognize the decision moment

- Need a next activity
- Plan changes
- Free time appears



2. Express the current context

- Practical context: time left, current location, budget, weather
- Experiential context: energy level, mood, desired atmosphere
- Social context: solo / duo / group, group preferences



3. Gather candidate options

- Reuse known options
 - Saved ideas
 - Existing plan
 - Backup ideas
- Find realistic local options
 - Nearby places
 - Currently feasible places



4. Filter and compare

- Remove unrealistic options
 - Too far
 - Closed
 - Too expensive
 - Poor fit
- Create a shortlist
 - Few strong options
 - Backup option
- Explain fit
 - Why it fits now
 - Main trade-offs



5. Choose and act

- Coordinate the choice
 - Discuss preferences
 - Select best option
- Move forward
 - Go to chosen place
 - Switch to backup if needed
 - Finish with confidence

4 Requirements Extraction

The requirements below are extracted from the context scenarios. They describe what information and capabilities TripFit must provide so that the personas can accomplish their goals.

4.1 Data Requirements

Data required	Purpose
Current location and available time	Determine what is realistic within the current trip moment.
Weather and time of day	Filter options that are no longer appropriate, such as outdoor places during rain or daytime-only activities in the evening.
User or group budget level	Avoid recommendations that create financial friction.
Mood, energy, and desired atmosphere	Match options to the user's current experiential goal, not only logistical constraints.
Group size and group preferences	Support shared decisions and avoid options that only fit one person.
Saved places, screenshots, map pins, or previous ideas	Reuse ideas users already care about instead of forcing them to start from zero.
Opening hours, travel time, price level, and distance	Evaluate practical feasibility.
Recent reviews, photos, crowd or wait-time signals	Support trust, recency, and confidence in the recommendation.
Existing plan or itinerary anchors	Help structured users adapt when a plan breaks without replacing the whole itinerary.

4.2 Functional Requirements

Function required	Reason
Capture current context with low effort	The interaction must stay lightweight and avoid adding complexity during an already stressful decision moment.
Import or reference saved options	Many users already collect ideas before the trip; the system should help filter them rather than ignore them.
Combine saved and nearby options	Users may need both inspiration they already saved and realistic alternatives around them.
Filter out unrealistic options	The system must remove options that are too far, closed, too expensive, too crowded, or mismatched to the current situation.
Generate a small shortlist	The system should reduce choice overload by presenting only a few strong candidates.
Explain why each option fits now	Users need transparent justification to trust the recommendation and reduce the gulf of evaluation.
Show trade-offs clearly	Users should understand why one option is closer, cheaper, calmer, livelier, or more effortful than another.
Support group alignment	The system should help multiple travelers express preferences quickly and converge on one shared choice.
Save a backup option	Since conditions can change, users need an intermediate result they can return to.
Support adaptation when plans fail	The system should help users repair a plan when weather, closures, fatigue, or delays change the situation.
Provide task closure	Once a choice is made, the system should confirm the decision and make the next action clear.
Allow easy exit or revision	Users should be able to change their mind, return to the shortlist, or choose a backup without feeling trapped.

5 Design Implication

TripFit should not behave like a generic recommendation engine or a complete itinerary planner. It should act as a lightweight decision-support tool for moments when travelers already have too many possible options and need help deciding what fits now. The design should reduce the gulf of execution by making the next step obvious, and reduce the gulf of evaluation by explaining why each recommendation is appropriate. The main interaction principle is therefore: fewer options, clearer reasons, and faster confidence.